

Home rules

Steps

- Have a family meeting – involve all family members in this discussion.
- Establish some rules (around five) that are important for all family members.
- Give each rule a name (so that you can remind without lecturing).
- Establish consequences for breaking the rule. Make the consequences fair and related to the broken rule.
- Put the rules where everyone can see them.
- Praise your child for following a family rule.
- When the rule is broken remain calm, state the rule and the consequence.
- Follow through with the consequence.
- Praise your child for the next respectful behaviour.



Home rules

Here are some examples of household rules. It is interesting to see what rules and consequences children suggest – they can be harder on themselves than we think! Make realistic and reasonable rules and review them every so often as some rules may not be necessary once they become habits.

Name	Rule	Consequence
Privacy	Knock before entering someone else's room	Do not go in that room for 24 hours
Property	Ask before using anyone else's possessions	Give item back. No using anyone else's things for 24 hours
Phone	Keep your phone charged and on loud. Answer calls/texts	No phone for 24 hours
Home time	Come home by the time agreed	Come home earlier (by the amount you were late) next time
Helmet	Wear helmet when riding your bike	No bike for 24 hours
Kindness	No teasing	Behaviour ignored until speak respectfully
Gentleness	No aggression will be tolerated	Time apart. Thinking time. Repair the damage